



Formula One

Formula One (F1) is a motorsport championship controlled by the Fédération Internationale de l'Automobile. Teams compete in a series of Grand Prix races, held in different countries around the world. Some of the most popular races are held in Monaco, Singapore, Italy and Britain. The Formula One cars are very fast, they reach speeds of up to 351 kilometres per hour (218 mph). The championship has been won by many different teams, including McLaren, Ferrari and Williams. Teams can have as many as 600 people. The teams all come together every race weekend. They use the expertise of each member try to win the race. The winning driver and team each get twenty-five points towards the Drivers' and Constructors' Championship. Teams consist of drivers, test drivers, a team principal, mechanics, engineers, and designers. Winning a race is affected by a good starting position, strategy, skill in pitstops and a fast car. The person with the most pole positions (fastest time set in qualifying) during a season gets a trophy. This was added in 2014. One of the longest tracks raced on was the Nürburgring, which is not used anymore.

The body that runs Formula One, the *Fédération Internationale de l'Automobile* (FIA),^[1] is based in France. Although Formula One is a 'billion dollar business', a drop in viewership and attendance figures at races has caused the FIA to make rule changes in recent years. These changes are meant to make the races more interesting, so more people watch F1 on television.

Safety

Drivers are paid large salaries to risk their lives every time they drive an F1 car. Like all types of motor racing, the dangers with Formula One are great. Because of this, there are many safety measures. Drivers wear 4 layers of flameproof overalls. They are made of a fire resistant material called Nomex. A drivers helmet must be able to resist an 800 °C (1,470 °F) flame for at least 45 seconds. They must also resist high G-forces. The helmets are very strong as well, even being able to withstand a truck driving over it.

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Formula One logo since 2018 (As of 2026)

Category	<u>Open-wheel single-seater</u> <u>Formula auto racing</u>
Country	Worldwide
First season	<u>1950</u>
Drivers	22
Teams	11
Engine makers	<u>Audi</u> <u>Ferrari</u> <u>Ford-RBPT</u> <u>Honda</u> <u>Mercedes</u>
Tire suppliers	<u>Pirelli</u>
Drivers' champion	 <u>Lando Norris</u> (2025) <u>McLaren-Mercedes</u>
Official website	<u>formula1.com</u> (<u>https://www.formula1.com/</u>)
 <u>Current season</u>	



Image of the Mercedes Benz W196 with which Juan Manuel Fangio won the 1954 and 1955 titles.

Cars

Carbon fiber is the ideal material for the body of Formula One cars, because it is light and strong. Because of this, the cars are very expensive to build and repair. The design of cars differs from team to team. Each team has two entries into the championship. This means that each team must build and maintain two cars . F1 currently uses Pirelli tires (5 compounds of slick tires and 2 compounds of non-slick tires for wet weather) Differing weather conditions need different tires. Wet weather driving is considered a skill in Formula One.

In 2021, The specifications of an F1 car is 786 kg minimum weight, 18 inch wheels and tires.^[2] Engines must be 1.6L V6 turbo hybrid intercooled and must reach higher than 3000rpm.^[3] The engine must be 4 stroke (Intake, Compression, Combustion and exhaust) and have a 90 degree angle between the V shape.



Fernando Alonso qualifying in a Renault Formula One car at the 2005 United States Grand Prix 



The safety car at the 2014 British Grand Prix. 

Related pages

- [Formula One racing](#)
- [List of Formula One broadcasters](#)
- [Formula One Grand Prix](#)

References

1. "2024 FIA Formula One World Championship" (<https://www.fia.com/events/fia-formula-one-world-championship/season-2024/2024-fia-formula-one-world-championship>). *Federation Internationale de l'Automobile*. 2012-03-12. Retrieved 2024-04-11.
2. Gemma Hatton-Deputy, ed. (2020-01-05). "What F1 2021 will look like" (<https://www.racecar-engineering.com/articles/f1-2021/>). *Racecar Engineering*. Retrieved 2022-04-09.
3. "Formula One Will Now Be Louder Than Ever Before | Endurance" (<https://www.endurancewarranty.com/learning-center/motorsports/formula-one-now-louder/>). *Endurance Warranty*. 19 December 2017. Retrieved 2021-11-11.



Charles Leclerc driving a Formula One car in 2022, Red Bull Ring, Austria. 



Michael Schumacher in the 2004 Ferrari Formula One car. 